FX Crossroads: Playtest, investigate and improve

Your role: You are a game tester and designer. Your job is to collect evidence and explain how the game could improve. You are assessed on your testing and reasoning, not your kills, mastery level or time spent playing.

Assignment A — Testing report and three improvements

1. Make a small test plan. Choose at least three areas: one combat test, one interface/navigation test and one other area of your choice. Multiplayer is optional if a partner or connection is unavailable.

2. Record the game version, device/browser, hero and mode, and whether Game Dev mode was active. Explain how you tested each area. Include working features and unsuccessful tests, not just problems.

3. Identify three distinct things that need improvement. These can be reproducible bugs, usability problems, balance concerns or performance issues. Explain which kind each is. A preference is not automatically a bug.

4. For each improvement, write: a clear title; exact steps; expected and observed behaviour; frequency (such as 2 failures in 3 attempts); evidence; impact on players; a proposed change; a trade-off or possible side effect; and a test that would show whether the change worked.

5. Rank the three improvements. Explain why the first is more important or urgent than the others. State what you did not test and what remains uncertain.

Repeat each issue test three times where practical. For an intermittent crash, do not repeatedly force a failing computer to crash; record the occurrence and use a safe comparison instead. Report “not reproduced” honestly.

Example of useful feedback

Weak: “The button is bad.”

Useful: “On my phone in landscape, I missed Secondary twice in five taps while moving. I expected the tap to trigger the skill; the hero kept moving without using it. My screenshot shows the finger-sized area I tried. I propose increasing the touch target while leaving space around the aim stick. This might cover more of the world, so I would compare successful taps and screen visibility in another five-tap test.”

This is an example format, not an observation you can claim as your own.

Suggested test areas

Area	Example question
Tutorial	Does the new-skill message explain the correct input? Can you resume and use it?

Area	Example question
Combat	Does the visible attack agree with where it damages? Can allies and enemies be distinguished?
Character Hall	Can you find a hero, understand the abilities and enter training?
Mobile	Can you move and use an ability simultaneously? Does rotation preserve usable controls?
Multiplayer	Can you join, change teams, start, respawn and play again? Record host/guest roles.
Profiles	With teacher permission, does a disposable profile retain expected progress after export/import?
Exploration	Can you follow paths, recognise interactions and understand objectives?
Performance	In the same area, what changes when school mode or the FPS cap changes?

The speed-check panel measures the current screen while solo AI is paused. It is not a benchmark of a full battle or the computer’s maximum capacity. Compare similar conditions and record limitations.

Tools in the game

- Menu → Options → Student playtest notebook: record tests, three improvements and reflection; copy or download your report.

- Copy bug-report details: inserts version/device/game context and reporting prompts. Add your own observations.

- Diagnostics: view the device/frame check or download crash information. A diagnostic file supplements your report; it does not replace it.

- Training Yard: compare attacks, healing, projectiles and movement safely.

- Mistglass: study enemies you have discovered.

Notebook drafts stay on this device and are separate from player profiles. Download your report before leaving, verify it in Downloads, then clear your notes. Nothing is submitted automatically: submit through the classroom method your teacher chooses. Attach screenshots separately and refer to their filenames in your report. Use a first name, initials or assigned student code only if your teacher requests it; reports do not require account passwords.

Game Dev testing

With teacher permission, speak to Elder Ram, choose the custom-question option and enter gameDev; when asked, enter R4ms. This is temporary testing access. It unlocks abilities/town features but does not earn progression, scores or transferable profile unlocks. Refresh or exit Game Dev mode to restore normal progression. Notebook reports can still be downloaded. Record which mode you used. Use a teacher-approved disposable normal profile for profile-transfer tests.

Suggested assessment — 30 marks (teacher may adapt)

Criterion	Marks	Evidence expected
Test plan and methods	6	At least three areas, clear steps/context, repeatable methods.
Three improvements	12	Four marks each: evidence, player impact, feasible change and verification.
Results and limitations	6	Expected vs observed, trials, passed tests, honest uncertainties.
Priorities and communication	6	Reasoned ranking, clear organisation, useful screenshots/references.

Winning, completing a difficult realm or finding a severe bug is not required for a high-quality report.

FX Crossroads: Design and learning reflection

Complete after the playtest report. Aim for 400–600 words, or use the headings below for a structured response. Your teacher may adapt the format or accept an equivalent oral/video reflection.

1. Evidence: Describe one specific thing you observed and how you tested it. What did you initially think, and what did repeated testing show?

2. Design: Explain one trade-off. Examples: damage versus reach; speed versus defence; richer graphics versus performance; more options versus clearer menus. Relate it to a real example from your tests.

3. Players: How might your experience differ for a new player, a mobile player, a player on a slower school computer or a teammate? Distinguish observed results from assumptions.

4. Collaboration: What did another player notice that you missed? If you tested alone, what comparison or second opinion would you seek?

5. Next step: Choose one improvement you would develop. Explain how you would prototype it and what result would show it helped. What evidence would change your mind?

Do not retell your entire play session. Connect claims to evidence and explain your reasoning. You may disagree with a design choice while recognising its purpose. Name an uncertainty rather than inventing evidence.

Suggested assessment — 20 marks

Criterion	Marks
Specific evidence from your testing	5
Thoughtful analysis of trade-offs and player needs	5
Reflection on learning/collaboration and uncertainty	5
Feasible next step with a way to evaluate it	5

Game progress, scores and enjoyment are not assessment criteria. Thoughtful criticism is welcome; explain it constructively.

Student playtest report

Version / date:

Device/browser:

Hero / mode / realm:

Solo or multiplayer (host/guest):

Game Dev or normal progression:

Test plan and results

Area	Exact method	Trials	Expected	Observed / pass or fail	Evidence
Combat					
Interface/navigation					
Chosen third area					

Improvement 1

Title and category:

Steps to reproduce:

Expected vs observed:

Frequency (failures / attempts):

Evidence and player impact:

Proposed improvement:

Trade-off / side effect:

How to verify it works:

Improvement 2

Title and category:

Steps to reproduce:

Expected vs observed:

Frequency (failures / attempts):

Evidence and player impact:

Proposed improvement:

Trade-off / side effect:

How to verify it works:

Improvement 3

Title and category:

Steps to reproduce:

Expected vs observed:

Frequency (failures / attempts):

Evidence and player impact:

Proposed improvement:

Trade-off / side effect:

How to verify it works:

Priorities and limitations

Rank the improvements and explain your first priority:

What you did not test:

What remains uncertain:

Next test:

Reflection (separate assignment)

Evidence that changed your thinking:

A design trade-off:

Different players’ needs:

Collaboration / second opinion:

Next design experiment and its evaluation:

Teacher guide: FX Crossroads playtesting

This pack is adaptable to your course/grade. It includes a testing-and-improvement assignment and a separate reflection. The game is a shared design artefact, not a test of gaming skill.

Suggested lesson sequence

- 5–10 minutes: demonstrate the notebook, a useful bug report, and the difference between a bug, preference, balance concern and performance symptom.

- 10 minutes: pairs choose a small plan with at least three areas. Assign different heroes/modes to spread coverage. A solo route should always be available.

- 20–30 minutes: test, repeat and record evidence. Swap tester/observer roles. Keep a version/device label on every report.

- 15–20 minutes: improve the report, select three changes and prioritise them.

- Separate follow-up: reflection, peer review, then re-test a later version against the proposed acceptance criteria.

Testing modes and shared devices

Game Dev access: Elder Ram → custom question → gameDev → R4ms. It unlocks testing features temporarily and excludes progression/profile transfers. Student notebook reports remain exportable. Refreshing/exiting restores the normal profile.

Use disposable normal profiles for save/import tests. Download and verify a student’s personal profile before clearing a shared computer. Notebook notes are stored separately: students download their report and clear notes. New/Clear player also removes the local notebook draft. Diagnostics and notes are never submitted automatically; set a classroom submission location.

Do not require intentional graphics crashes, unsafe device changes, access to another student’s profile or public sharing of identifiable reports. An observed crash can be documented with the existing diagnostic report and a safe follow-up comparison.

Coverage suggestions

Divide a class across: onboarding/UI, melee/ranged/support/summoner controls, mobile layout, realm navigation/objectives, PvP respawn/replay, co-op connections, profile transfer, and performance on school hardware. Each student can investigate a small slice thoroughly. Do not require all modes or all heroes.

Assessment and accommodations

Assess evidence, methods, player impact, proposed change, trade-offs and verification. Do not assess mastery level, kills, speedrun time or ability to complete difficult content. Allow diagrams, annotated screenshots, structured bullets or recorded explanations where appropriate. No reproduction is not a failure if reported accurately.

A design improvement can earn full credit without a programming implementation. Extension: students sketch a UI/ability change, define acceptance tests and later implement a small reversible change using ABILITY_CATALOG.md.

Closing the feedback loop

Group duplicate reports. Pick one urgent defect, one usability fix and one design experiment. Give students the resulting release notes and ask them to re-run their original tests. Require evidence before declaring “fixed.” This connects observation → proposal → implementation → evaluation.